

# Texas Doughnut

Plate-size yeast-raised — Texas-sized / Shipley's-lineage crumb · ~8–9" ring · tall, cottony-light · crackle-set glaze in four finishes

| YIELD             | FLOUR              | HYDRATION | FRY           |
|-------------------|--------------------|-----------|---------------|
| ~5 @ 8–9" + holes | Sir Lancelot 14.2% | ~58% eff. | 350°F / 177°C |

## FORMULA — BAKER'S PERCENTAGES

Flour = 100% · scale to any flour weight

|                                                                                                           |      |        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|--------|
| Bread flour — Sir Lancelot / Shepherd's Grain Opus (~14%); strength to tower the jumbo ring through proof | 100% | 1000 g |
| Whole milk — hydration + tenderness; hold a little back, add to feel                                      | 52%  | 520 g  |
| Whole egg — 3 large; structure, lift, color                                                               | 15%  | 150 g  |
| Butter, softened — tender crumb, shelf life                                                               | 12%  | 120 g  |
| Granulated sugar — yeast food + Maillard browning                                                         | 12%  | 120 g  |
| Instant yeast — capped at 2%; more risks over-proof collapse at this size                                 | 2%   | 20 g   |
| Kosher salt (by weight) — yeast regulation, flavor, gluten tightening                                     | 1.5% | 15 g   |
| Vanilla extract — flavor                                                                                  | 1%   | 10 g   |

## GLAZE BASE Classic vanilla · crackle-set shellac

|                            |       |
|----------------------------|-------|
| Powdered sugar             | 250 g |
| Whole milk                 | 50 g  |
| Light corn syrup / glucose | 20 g  |
| Vanilla to taste           | —     |
| Kosher salt pinch          | —     |

Warm to ~40°C, dip warm doughnuts, drip on a rack. The corn syrup is what gives the thin translucent crackle-set shellac.

## DOUGH READ Drive the dough, not the gram count

**Finish by feel:** soft, smooth, slightly tacky — **not slack**. Effective hydration is ~58% once the egg's water is counted. **Hi-gluten flour drinks more water** than the standard bread flour this style is usually written for, so at 52% milk the dough may feel stiff — add the last of the milk (and a splash beyond if needed) to reach the soft-tacky finish. An enriched dough must be **fully developed** or it won't tower.

## GLAZE VARIATIONS

One base — divide & augment to a thin ribbon

Make the base, divide into bowls, stir in the add-in, then correct each back to a **thin ribbon that coats and crackle-sets** — a little more powdered sugar if it loosens, a few drops of liquid if it stiffens. Amounts are per full base batch; scale to the portion you're flavoring.

|             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chocolate   | Sift in <b>40 g Dutch-process cocoa</b> , then add <b>~30 g milk</b> to re-loosen — cocoa drinks liquid, so thin it back to a ribbon. Dutch cocoa gives darker color and a smoother, less-acidic finish.                                                                      |
| Strawberry  | Stir in <b>25 g freeze-dried strawberry powder</b> (blitz fine, sift the seeds out); splash of milk if stiff. Natural pink, <b>no dye</b> . Freeze-dried adds flavor + color but <b>no water</b> , so the crackle-set holds — skip fresh purée, it weeps and runs on a jumbo. |
| Lemon-Poppy | Add <b>zest of 2 lemons + 8 g poppy seeds</b> , and use <b>fresh lemon juice in place of the milk</b> for the liquid. The zest oil carries the aroma, the juice brings the acid bite, the poppy the crunch.                                                                   |

# Execution

| OIL           | ROLL | FRY          | BATCH       |
|---------------|------|--------------|-------------|
| 350°F / 177°C | ½"   | ~90 s / side | 1 at a time |

## MIX · BULK · CUT

- Mix:** combine dries (flour, sugar, kosher salt, instant yeast) + egg, milk, vanilla → shaggy mass.
- Knead to near-windowpane BEFORE the butter.** The structure has to be there first.
- Add softened butter;** knead to smooth, elastic, slightly tacky. Finish by feel — hi-gluten flour may want a splash more milk.
- Bulk ferment** to doubled, ~1–1.5 h at room temp. **Or cold-retard overnight** — deeper flavor, firmer dough, cleaner cuts.
- Sheet** cold dough to an **even ½"** across the whole slab — don't go thicker; a plate-size ring at ¾" sags and risks a raw center.
- Cut ~8.5" outer / ~2.5" hole** (band ~3"). **Do NOT twist the cutter** — sealed edges won't rise. The **band width is the structural knob**: weak dough or sagging → go to a bigger hole.
- Transfer each ring to its own ~10" parchment square.** The paper is the transfer tool — a giant proofed ring tears if you lift it by hand.

## PROOF · FRY · GLAZE

- Final proof, 45–60 min**, covered loosely. Done when puffy and light, and a gentle poke holds a **slow-filling** indent — it should not spring fully back.
- Heat oil** (canola / peanut / shortening) to **350°F / 177°C**. **Wide flat-bottomed vessel ~12–14"** (cast iron / flat-bottom wok / braiser), **2–3" oil, half-full max**, on a high-BTU outdoor burner. Clip a thermometer; **modulate the flame** — that much oil + propane overshoots fast.
- Lower each doughnut on its parchment, proof-side down.** After ~5–10 s the paper releases — pull it with tongs and discard.
- Fry ONE at a time, ~90 s/side at ½"**, deep golden, **ONE flip with two spiders** (it's big and fragile). **Watch the white equator belt, not the clock.**
- Drain** on a wire rack over a sheet. **Glaze warm** (formula, page 1).

**Time = thickness, not diameter.** An 8–9" plate ring and a 6" ring at the same ½" fry in the same ~90 s/side window — the oil drives heat through the same ½" either way. Going bigger costs you a wider pan and careful handling, **not** fry time.

## FRY & FIX

Fry by observation — root cause → correction

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Oil temp drifts               | Clip a thermometer, check <b>every batch</b> . Below 350°F → greasy; above ~365°F → outside darkens before the center cooks. Hold 350°F and let it recover between drops.                                      |
| Greasy / oil-logged           | Oil too cold or sagged after the drop, <b>or</b> over-proofed (weak structure soaks oil). Hold 350°F; <b>one at a time</b> (a plate ring fills the pan) so temp recovers.                                      |
| Ring sags / tears on transfer | Band too thin, dough under-developed, or over-proofed for the span. Widen the band ( <b>bigger hole</b> ), develop fully, proof a touch under, and move it on the parchment — never lift a giant ring by hand. |
| Raw center, dark crust        | Oil too hot. Drop the temp.                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| No white belt                 | Flipped more than once, oil too cold, or under-proofed. <b>Flip ONCE</b> at golden — color, not clock.                                                                                                         |
| Dense, tight crumb            | Under-proofed, or gluten under-developed. Proof to a slow-filling poke; develop to near-windowpane before the butter.                                                                                          |
| Collapsed after proof         | Over-proofed — too much gas for the gluten to hold. The poke should fill back <b>slowly</b> , not vanish.                                                                                                      |
| Glaze weeps / runs off        | Doughnut too hot when glazed, or dough over-hydrated. Cool slightly before dipping.                                                                                                                            |